

# The Great Sūtra on What Accords with Wandering Everywhere and Not Wandering Everywhere

Āṭānāṭīya-mahāsūtra · Toh 656 · Derge Kangyur

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The Āṭānāṭīya Mahāsūtra, known in Tibetan as the Great Sūtra on What Accords with Wandering Everywhere and Not Wandering Everywhere, is Toh 656 in the Kangyur, classified among the collection's sūtras. It belongs to a well-known Buddhist textual tradition associated with the protection dhāraṇī called the Āṭānāṭīya, which is recited for warding off malevolent spirits and safeguarding practitioners. The sūtra is set at Śrāvastī, where the Great King Vaiśravaṇa — one of the four guardian kings and lord of the yakṣas — visits the Buddha by night with a vast retinue of yakṣas, introducing what becomes a discourse on the powerful protective formula associated with his name and domain. This text is part of a broader canonical tradition found across various Buddhist schools, and its inclusion in the Kangyur reflects the importance placed on protective ritual literature within Tibetan Buddhist practice.

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In the language of India: Āṭānāṭīya-mahāsūtra nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Great Sūtra on What Accords with Wandering Everywhere and Not Wandering Everywhere.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, of brilliant complexion, accompanied by many yakṣa retainers, by many hundreds of yakṣa retainers, by many thousands of yakṣa retainers, and by many hundreds of thousands of yakṣa retainers, when the night had grown still, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. At that time, by the power of the brilliant complexion of the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, the entire Jeta Grove was illuminated with a great light.

Seated to one side, the Great King Vaiśravaṇa then offered these verses:

O perfect buddha, best among two-footed beings,  
what you, O wise one, have come to know  
was not sought out even by the gods.  
To you, O great hero, I pay homage.

To all the buddhas who have passed away,  
those who have appeared now, and those yet to come —  
to all of them I pay homage,  
and to you as well I come for refuge.

Venerable one, among the śrāvaka disciples of the Blessed One — the monks, the nuns, the laymen, and the laywomen — there are those who dwell in hermitages, forest edges, and border regions. Among them there are yakṣas and non-humans who are innately malevolent, some of whom are devoted to the sacred words of the Blessed One and some of whom are not. Those yakṣas and innately malevolent non-humans who are devoted to the sacred words of the Blessed One are exceedingly few, while those yakṣas and innately malevolent non-humans who are not devoted to the sacred words of the Blessed One are very many. Therefore, venerable one, in order to guard, protect, and establish in comfort the monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen among the śrāvaka disciples of the Blessed One; to bring those yakṣas and innately malevolent non-humans who are not devoted to faith; and to further increase and multiply those who are already devoted — it would be excellent if this very sūtra that accords with wandering everywhere and not wandering everywhere, together with its vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-treading salutations, were to be held in its fullness and brought to complete fulfillment.

When he had said "Excellent! Excellent!" the Blessed One signified his approval of the Great King Vaiśravaṇa by remaining silent.

Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, understanding that the Blessed One had granted approval through his silence, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and at that time, in the presence of the Blessed One, he recited at length this very sūtra that accords with wandering everywhere and not wandering everywhere, together with its vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-treading salutations:

Those people who are generous and liberal,  
who speak no slander and are free from miserliness,  
who have gone to the buddha for refuge —  
it is those people who obtain their aims.

The one upon whose arising it is then  
that the great sun, possessing its disk,  
is said by day to shine —

the direction in which that sun rises,  
that direction I shall protect.

The great and illustrious king  
is the king who rules over the gandharvas.  
His name is called Dhṛtarāṣṭra.  
Together with his kindred all around,  
he sports forever in song and dance.  
He is encircled by gandharvas on every side,  
and gandharvas look upon him face to face.  
He has many sons —  
eighty and ten and one.

All of them bear the same renowned name:  
they are called Indra, mighty in power.  
In the battle between gods and asuras,  
none can overcome them from any side.  
These sons of his beheld the fully awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
and said: "O man of noble birth, we bow to you.  
O supreme being, we pay homage to you."  
Thus did human beings pay homage to you,  
standing far off and bowing in reverence.  
"Look upon us with virtue, we pray.  
Non-humans too bow in homage to you" —  
these words he heard again and again.

And so for that reason I say this:  
"Seek homage to the Victor, the Guide!  
Seek homage to the Victor, the Gautama!  
The buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct,  
gone beyond sorrow — to him I offer homage!"  
Thus is the eastern direction said by people to be good.  
The great and illustrious one  
is the guardian who protects that direction.

Concerning that place known as the realm of hungry ghosts:  
there dwell those who crave the flesh of the back, who are slanderous,  
who commit killing, who are wicked,  
who are fearful and speak harsh words.

The great and illustrious one  
who protects that direction overtly  
is the king who rules over the kumbhāṇḍas.  
His name is called Virūḍhaka.  
Together with his kindred all around,  
he sports forever in song and dance.  
He is encircled by kumbhāṇḍas on every side,  
and kumbhāṇḍas look upon him face to face.  
He has many sons —  
eighty and ten and one.  
All of them bear the same renowned name:  
they are called Indra, mighty in power.  
In the battle between gods and asuras,  
none can overcome them from any side.  
These sons of his beheld the fully awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
and said: "O man of noble birth, we bow to you.  
O supreme being, we pay homage to you."  
Thus did human beings pay homage to you,  
standing far off and bowing in reverence.  
"Look upon us with virtue, we pray.  
Non-humans too bow in homage to you" —  
these words he heard again and again.  
And so for that reason I say this:  
"Seek homage to the Victor, the Guide!  
Seek homage to the Victor, the Gautama!  
The buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct,  
gone beyond sorrow — to him I offer homage!"  
Thus is the southern direction said by people to be good.  
The great and illustrious one  
is the guardian who protects that direction.  
  
As for that which sets in the west alone —  
because of that it is spoken of as belonging to the night —  
the great sun, possessing its disk,  
the solar canopy that disappears below:  
in that place there is a great and deep ocean,

extremely difficult to cross.  
It is known as the blue sea,  
understood by people as such.  
The great and illustrious one  
who openly protects that direction  
is the king who rules over the nāgas.  
His name is called Virūpākṣa.  
Together with his kindred all around,  
he sports forever in song and dance.  
He is encircled by nāgas on every side,  
and nāgas look upon him face to face.  
He has many sons —  
eighty and ten and one.  
All of them bear the same renowned name:  
they are called Indra, mighty in power.  
In the battle between gods and asuras,  
none can overcome them from any side.  
These sons of his beheld the fully awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
and said: "O man of noble birth, we bow to you.  
O supreme being, we pay homage to you."  
Thus did human beings pay homage to you,  
standing far off and bowing in reverence.  
"Look upon us with virtue, we pray.  
Non-humans too bow in homage to you" —  
these words he heard again and again.  
And so for that reason I say this:  
"Seek homage to the Victor, the Guide!  
"O Gautama, we seek homage to you —  
to the buddha, endowed with knowledge and feet.  
We come to pay homage to one gone beyond sorrow."  
And so it is of the western direction  
that people say: "It is good."  
The one who governs that direction with distinction  
is the Great King of renowned fame.

Now in the north there is Śrī Mīśravaṇa —  
delightful, with a great and beautiful peak.  
There the people live for lives  
of a full thousand years.  
They do not plow the earth, nor do they sow.  
They do not use the plowshare to till,  
yet they are long-lived and of fine complexion,  
and they live in complete sufficiency.  
Their food is sāli rice, colored and fragrant,  
endowed with scent and flavor,  
assembled like a cluster of fragrant flowers —  
they seek what resembles the nectar of the gods.  
Coconuts are cooked and prepared,  
and that is taken as a relish — not mere beans.  
Where there is a plant with tips like tongues of flame  
that chirps and sings with delight —  
the one who governs that direction with distinction  
is the Great King of renowned fame.  
He is the lord king of the yakṣas,  
and his name is called Virūḍhaka.  
He takes pleasure always, together with his kinsmen,  
in song and dance without cease.  
He is surrounded on all sides by yakṣas,  
with yakṣas looking on before him.  
He has many sons —  
eighty and eleven.  
These bear the same renowned name:  
they are called Indra, mighty in power.  
In the battle between gods and asuras,  
none can overcome them from any side.  
These sons of his beheld the fully awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
and said: "O man of noble birth, we bow to you.  
O supreme being, we pay homage to you."  
Thus did human beings pay homage to you,  
standing far off and bowing in reverence.  
"Look upon us with virtue, we pray.  
Non-humans too bow in homage to you" —

these words he heard again and again.  
And so for that reason I say this:  
"Seek homage to the Victor, the Guide!  
O Gautama the Victor, we seek homage to you —  
to the buddha, endowed with knowledge and feet.  
We come to pay homage to one gone beyond sorrow."

And so it is of the northern direction  
that people say: "It is good."  
The one who governs that direction with distinction  
is the Great King of renowned fame.

In the eastern direction: Dhṛtarāṣṭra.  
In the southern direction: Virūḍhaka.  
In the western direction: Virūpākṣa.  
In the northern direction: Vaiśravaṇa.

These four great kings, of renowned fame,  
are guardians of the world.  
Possessed of great miraculous power and great strength,  
they guard the four directions.

The yakṣas who serve at the command of the kings,  
who come to fulfill all desires —  
these seek out elephants  
and roam about in every direction.

By these are sought horses, she-elephants, the finest of herds, buffalo, rams,  
ewes, serpents, birds, men, women, youths, and maidens — and they go in  
every direction.

One elephant draws a chariot, and they also go in every direction.  
A single riding horse, a she-elephant, the finest of herds, a buffalo, a ram, a  
ewe, a serpent, a bird, a man, a woman, a youth, and a maiden each draws a  
chariot, and they go in every direction.

The yakṣas who come to fulfill all desires, possessed of great miraculous  
power and great strength —  
having obtained those mounts,  
they guard the four directions.

The kings have retinue-cities  
of various kinds that travel through the sky —

namely: the ever-wandering, those that do not wander, those that do not wander upon the earth, those that wander upon the earth with dancing, those that are hollow, and those called hollow cities.

In the north there is also the lake called Kapivanka.

In the west there are cities called Sarpasara, Navanavati, Vasumati, Padmavati, Supadma, and Prithivi.

That place has become the abode of many streams; there is a lake called Ādhāra. From it flow various streams, and from it heavenly rains descend.

Reverend one, beyond the hollow city of Uśira: there are places of bodily abiding, and spacious abiding-places, and beyond those, places with streams flowing in their courses — many with flowing streams, and beyond those still more — appearing in the intermediate sky and the heavens like birds.

Reverend one, to the north of the hollow cities there is an assembly ground called the place of dancers (Nṛtyabhūmi). There the yakṣas gather and dwell. Among them are those with ugly feet and drooping lips, and those with fearsome bristling bellies. There the trees bear fruit without cease. Peacocks, cranes with melodious calls, cuckoos with their great resounding cries, and the śaṅkhaṭeyu birds all give voice. The sounds of the peacocks, too — the gaukomṛdha and the cañcalā birds and various other birds — raise their calls, delighting in the taste of flowers and honey. Those of unpleasant bodies sport with singing and dancing, playing together with the lotus-born ones.

Reverend one, beyond the willow city (Vañjulavatī) lies the country of the king called Vīra, in the border regions of his realm. The assembly ground where I dwell is called the excellent herd (Uccaiśravas). My name is the Son of Vaiśravaṇa. The words of the secret mantra are these: tayathā — ili mili, ili mili, kiṭṭi mūle, hili kiṭṭi mūle, huḍu me, huḍu raḍu me, gauri, gandhari, goḍohani, oke moke svāhā.

Reverend one, before the Blessed One I shall now recite the names of the gandharvas, the great gandharvas, the gandharva chieftains, and the military commanders. They are as follows:

Intoxicated by desire, intoxicated by the joy of pleasure,  
intoxicated by song — the brothers — intoxicated by garlands,  
intoxicated by honey, intoxicated by flowers — the brothers —  
ever intoxicated, and intoxicated by splendor,

intoxicated by wealth, the joy-makers,  
Utpala, Padma, Candra,  
the one who holds the five, and the cuckoo-voiced,  
Tumburu, the five-crested,  
the golden-natured maidens and the golden ones,  
Pāvasaṅga and the swift ones —  
however many lords of wandering and of stillness there may be,  
these are my brothers.

I declare to them: "This gandharva is harming me; this gandharva will not release me" — and I cause this to be known to them. When any gandharva, male or female, old gandharva man or old gandharva woman, gandharva son or gandharva daughter, male attendant of a gandharva or female attendant of a gandharva, or a gandharva emissary or gandharva emissary woman, who causes harm and watches for an opening and seeks an opportunity, draws near, stands near, or comes into proximity — if they hear these words well spoken, their head shall be split into seven pieces like the pod of the ārdaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra are these: tayathā — kuṇḍule, kuṇḍule, kuṇḍule, kuṇḍuphe, ehi ehi, sadāmatike, sadābhaṇḍinike, tiṣṭha tuṣṭa, baddho si svāhā.

Reverend one, if a certain śrāvaka of the Blessed One — whether a monk, a nun, a layman, or a laywoman — thoroughly learns by heart and recites this sūtra that accords with both those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander, together with its vidyā mantras, its protection, and its veneration at the feet of the swift-footed ones, and if any male gandharva, female gandharva, old male gandharva, old female gandharva, gandharva son, gandharva daughter, male attendant of a gandharva, female attendant of a gandharva, gandharva emissary, or female gandharva emissary who seeks to cause harm, watching for and searching out an opening, should draw near to that person, stand nearby, or come into their presence — they shall find no opening and no foothold; they shall not gain entry into the gathering-place where the gandharvas assemble; they shall not find a place in the willow palace of the king; and their head shall be split into seven pieces like the pod of the ārdaka plant.

Reverend one, if a śrāvaka of the Blessed One — a monk —

or a nun, or a layman, or a laywoman who has received this very text in full scriptural transmission and recites it — a text that accords with the sūtras of the wandering ones and of those who are not wandering ones, together with the vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-prostrations — if any flesh-eater (rākṣasa), female flesh-eater, elder flesh-eater, elder female flesh-eater, son of a flesh-eater, daughter of a flesh-eater, male attendant of a flesh-eater, female attendant of a flesh-eater, male emissary of a flesh-eater, or female emissary of a flesh-eater who seeks to cause harm, watching for and searching out an opening, should draw near to that person, stand nearby, or come into their presence — they shall find no opening and no foothold; they shall not gain entry into the inner gathering-place where the flesh-eaters assemble; they shall not find a place in the willow palace of the king; and their head shall be split into seven pieces like the pod of the ārdaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — hu me hu me, hu me le, hu mi la, bātīye svāhā.

Reverend one, in the presence of the Blessed One, I shall now proclaim the names of the kumbhāṇḍas, the great kumbhāṇḍas, the kumbhāṇḍa commanders, and the military commanders, and make them known:

Jina and Niyajina, Krimisha,  
Great-ribbed and Great-bellied,  
Ten-armed and Earth-roaming,  
Dark on the left side, red,  
Cloud-colored and Stainless,  
Long-eared and Thunder-voiced,  
Matted-haired and Ten-powered,  
Existence-accomplishing and Fulfiller of all desires,  
The Stable one and the Secret-actioned,  
The three endowed with excellent gifts,  
All-colored and Bright-eyed —  
all those who move and abide wherever they may be.

These are my kindred. To them I say: this kumbhāṇḍa is harming me; this kumbhāṇḍa will not release me. And I make this known to them.

The kumbhāṇḍa that harms me  
and the kumbhāṇḍa that will not release me —  
should they hear these well-spoken words,  
like the pod of the ārdaka plant

their head shall be split into seven pieces.

The words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — sire bi sire, sire bi sare, sire bi sare, kṛṣṇa tsagale, karāḍa, piṃgale svāhā.

Reverend one, if a śrāvaka of the Blessed One — a monk, or a nun, or a layman, or a laywoman — who has received this very text in full scriptural transmission and recites it — a text that accords with the sūtras of the wandering ones and of those who are not wandering ones, together with the vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-prostrations — if any kumbhāṇḍa, female kumbhāṇḍa, elder kumbhāṇḍa, elder female kumbhāṇḍa, son of a kumbhāṇḍa, daughter of a kumbhāṇḍa, male attendant of a kumbhāṇḍa, female attendant of a kumbhāṇḍa, male emissary of a kumbhāṇḍa, or female emissary of a kumbhāṇḍa who seeks to cause harm, watching for and searching out an opening, should draw near to that person, stand nearby, or come into their presence — they shall find no opening and no foothold; they shall not gain entry into the inner gathering-place where the kumbhāṇḍas assemble in their boats; they shall not find a place in the willow palace of the king; and their head shall be split into seven pieces like the pod of the ārdaka plant.

Reverend one, if a śrāvaka of the Blessed One — a monk, or a nun, or a layman, or a laywoman — who has received this very text in full scriptural transmission and recites it — a text that accords with the sūtras of the wandering ones and of those who are not wandering ones, together with the vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-prostrations — if any hungry ghost (preta), female hungry ghost, elder hungry ghost, elder female hungry ghost, son of a hungry ghost, daughter of a hungry ghost, male attendant of a hungry ghost, female attendant of a hungry ghost, or male emissary of a hungry ghost — a female emissary of a hungry ghost who does harm while watching for and seeking an opening — should draw near, stand near, or come near to that person, that one will find no opening and find no foothold, and will not be able to enter into the assembly-place of the hungry ghosts, and will obtain no dwelling even in the royal palace of the willows. That one's head will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra for that are these:

tadyathā: yumi yumi, yumili, yumilā vātiye svāhā.

Reverend Blessed One, before your eyes I shall now recite the names of the nāgas, the great nāgas, the nāga chieftains, and the nāga generals. They are as follows:

Joy, Nearjoy, Universal Joy,  
Wealth-Grown and Good Jambu,  
Yellow One and Milk-Ear,  
Indra's Hand and Auspicious,  
Sorrowless and Free-of-Sorrow,  
Fully Liberated and Lord-of-Victors,  
Broad-Face and Bright-Face,  
Vaiśālī and Auspicious-Bowing-King,  
Great Confidence and Star-Joy,  
Great Black One and Hand-Goer,  
Goat-Keeper and Abider,  
The Left Direction and likewise Black One,  
Blue-Purified-White and Companion —  
however many dwell and move throughout the worlds.

Those are my kinsmen. To them I declare: "This nāga harms me; this nāga will not release me." And I make this known to them. Should those nāgas who harm me and who will not release me hear these well-spoken words, their heads will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra for that are these:

tadyathā: cile vicile, cile vicile, gauṛī, gāndhārī, matangi, caṇḍāli svāhā.

Furthermore, reverend Blessed One, if any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — a monk, or a nun, or a layman, or a laywoman — who has received this very text in full scriptural transmission and recites it — this text that accords with the sūtras of the wandering ones and of those who are not wandering ones, together with the vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-prostrations — if any nāga, female nāga, elder nāga, elder female nāga, son of a nāga, daughter of a nāga, male attendant of a nāga, female attendant of a nāga, male emissary of a nāga, or female emissary of a nāga who does harm while watching for and seeking an opening should draw near, stand near, or come near to that person, that one will find no opening and find no foothold, and will not be able to enter into the assembly-place of the nāgas, and will obtain no dwelling even in the royal palace of the willows. That one's head will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

Furthermore, reverend Blessed One, if any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — a monk, or a nun, or a layman, or a laywoman — who has received this very text in full scriptural transmission and recites it — this text that accords with the sūtras of the wandering ones and of those who are not wandering ones, together with the vidyā-mantras, protective spells, and foot-prostrations — if any corpse-spirit (vetāla), female corpse-spirit, elder corpse-spirit, elder female corpse-spirit, son of a corpse-spirit, daughter of a corpse-spirit, male attendant of a corpse-spirit, female attendant of a corpse-spirit, male emissary of a corpse-spirit, or female emissary of a corpse-spirit who does harm while watching for and seeking an opening should draw near, stand near, or come near to that person, that one will find no opening and find no foothold, and will not be able to enter into the assembly-place of the corpse-spirits, and will obtain no dwelling even in the royal palace of the willows. That one's head will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra for that are these:

tadyathā: abe vahaṇa vatiye svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, in your presence I shall now recite the names of the yakṣas, the great yakṣas, the yakṣa chieftains, and the yakṣa generals. They are as follows:

Mighty Moon, Lord of Waters,  
Bharadvāja, Master of Beings,  
Powerful Candana, Chief of Desires,  
Evil-Throat and Sure-Neck,  
Strong Jewel and Jewel-User,  
Supreme Sound and Near-Drum,  
Mountain-Equal, Golden, and Filled,  
Śiṃśapā-Dweller and Left-Handed,  
Yakṣa Protector who dwells in the wilds,  
Victor, Best of Herds, King of Men,  
The many hosts of gandharvas (celestial fragrance-eaters),  
Long Iron-Spear and Endowed-with-Mother,  
Five-Syllable Yellow Delight,  
Long Yakṣa and his retinue,  
Triple-Fruit and Triple-Neck,  
And all others that dwell and wander wherever they may be.

These are my kinsmen, and to them I declare: this yakṣa here is harming me; this yakṣa will not release me. And I make this known to them.

If a yakṣa who harms me, or a yakṣa who will not release me, hears these well-spoken words, that one's head will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra for that are these:

tadyathā: hile mile, hile mile, kīrtimūli, hili kīrtimūle, otumbe tumbe, otumbe, tumbe, o ghe mo ghe, go dehi, bhṛṃgāre, ṛṣisattame svāhā.

If any monk or nun, layman or laywoman who is a śrāvaka of the Venerable Blessed One — whether one who wanders or one who does not wander — recites this sūtra in accordance with the vidyā-mantra, the protective spell, and the branch of bowing at the feet, transmitting it extensively and proclaiming it, and if some yakṣa — male or female, elder male or elder female, son of a yakṣa or daughter of a yakṣa, male attendant of a yakṣa or female attendant of a yakṣa, male emissary of a yakṣa or female emissary of a yakṣa — who does harm, who watches for and seeks an opening, should draw near, stand near, or come near to that person, that one will find no opening and find no foothold, will not be able to enter into the assembly-place of the yakṣas, and will obtain no dwelling even in the royal palace of the willows. That one's head will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

If any monk or nun, layman or laywoman who is a śrāvaka of the Venerable Blessed One — whether one who wanders or one who does not wander — recites this sūtra in accordance with the vidyā-mantra, the protective spell, and the branch of bowing at the feet, transmitting it extensively and proclaiming it, and if some rakṣasa (a demon) — male or female, elder male or elder female, son of a rakṣasa or daughter of a rakṣasa, male attendant of a rakṣasa or female attendant of a rakṣasa, male emissary of a rakṣasa or female emissary of a rakṣasa — who does harm, who watches for and seeks an opening, should draw near, stand near, or come near to that person, that one will find no opening and find no foothold, will not be able to enter into the assembly-place of the rakṣasas, and will obtain no dwelling even in the royal palace of the willows. That one's head will be split into seven pieces, like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra for that are these:

tadyathā: hili hili, hulu hulu, yume yume le, yumilavaṭīye svāhā.

Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, in the presence of the Blessed One, began with the sūtra in accordance with wandering and non-wandering, the vidyā-mantra, the protective spell, and —

having paid homage at the feet of the sūtra, he then elaborated upon this at length and, bowing his head in homage at the feet of the Blessed One, vanished from that very place.

Then the Blessed One, when that same night had passed, took his seat on the throne that had been prepared for the head of the monastic Saṅgha of monks. Having taken his seat, the Blessed One spoke to the monks:

"Monks, last night the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, of radiant and noble complexion, attended by many yakṣa retinues, by retinues of many hundreds of yakṣas, by retinues of many thousands of yakṣas, by retinues of many hundreds of thousands of yakṣas — when dawn broke, he came to me where I was, and having come, he bowed his head in homage at my feet and sat to one side. At that time, by the power of the Great King Vaiśravaṇa's radiance, the entire Jeta Grove shone forth with a great illumination. And the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, seated to one side, then recited these verses:

O perfect buddha, noble among bipeds,  
what you, the wise one, have known —  
even the gods have not found that.  
O great hero, I bow to you.

To all the buddhas who have gone before,  
those arisen now, and those yet to come,  
to all of them I pay homage;  
in you as well I take my refuge.

Venerable Blessed One, among your śrāvaka disciples — the monks, the nuns, the laymen, and the laywomen — there are those dwelling in remote lodgings and hermitages, in forest edges, and at the margins of wastelands. And dwelling there are yakṣas and malevolent non-humans of inherently harmful nature, some of whom have faith in the Blessed One's scriptural teaching and some of whom have no faith. Now those yakṣas and malevolent non-humans of inherently harmful nature who do have faith in the Blessed One's scriptural teaching are very few indeed, while those yakṣas and malevolent non-humans of inherently harmful nature who have no faith in the Blessed One's scriptural teaching are exceedingly many.

Venerable Blessed One, in order that the śrāvaka disciples — the monks and nuns, the laymen and laywomen — may in this manner protect themselves, be guarded, and abide in the touch of well-being; and in order that those yakṣas and malevolent non-humans of inherently harmful nature who lack faith may be turned toward faith, and that those who already have faith may in turn flourish and increase — it would be excellent if this very sūtra in accordance with wandering and non-wandering, along with the vidyā-mantra, the protective spell, and the one that brings homage at the feet of the sūtra, were extensively received and brought to complete fulfilment.

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One, by saying nothing to the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, granted his assent. Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, knowing from the Blessed One's silence that assent had been granted, bowed his head in homage at my feet and, in my presence, extensively recited this very sūtra in accordance with wandering and non-wandering, the vidyā-mantra, the protective spell, and the one that brings homage at the feet of the sūtra:

Those beings who are generous and bold,  
free from slander and free from miserliness,  
those who go for refuge to the buddha —  
it is those persons who obtain what is found.

In dependence on whose rising,  
it is proclaimed throughout the day:  
the great sun with its orb of brilliance,  
the direction from which the solar parasol will rise —  
that direction he guards and protects.

The great king endowed with glory,  
the king who is lord of the gandharvas (celestial musicians),  
his name is known as Dhṛtarāṣṭra.

Together with his kin and companions,

always reveling in song and dance,  
surrounded on all sides by gandharvas,  
with gandharvas facing him.

He has many sons —  
eighty and eleven —

all of them bearing the same renowned name:

Powerful Ones (Indras), they are called, of great strength,  
unconquered in battle against gods and asuras

by any other, anywhere.

All of them, upon beholding the perfectly awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,

bow to you who are skilled in all things, O man among men:

"To you, the supreme being, we pay homage!" —

thus humans have paid homage to you,

standing at a distance and bowing.

May you look upon us with virtue.

We heard again and again

that even non-humans (asuras and the like) pay homage to you.

Therefore I too say this:

"Seek homage before the Victor, the Guide!

Seek homage before the Victor Gautama!

To the buddha endowed with knowledge and conduct perfected,

to the one who has passed into nirvāṇa, we pay homage!"

Thus it is that people say the eastern direction

is an auspicious one.

The great king of renown

who guards and protects that direction —

in that region there are those called hungry ghosts (pretas),

those who seek flesh behind one's back, those who spread slander,

those who commit killing, the malevolent,

the cowardly and those who speak harsh words.

The great king of renown

who guards and protects that direction

is the lord and king of the kumbhāṇḍas (gourd-shaped spirits),

and his name is known as Virūḍhaka (Noble-Born).

He, together with his kin and companions,

is always reveling in song and dance,

surrounded on all sides by kumbhāṇḍas,

with kumbhāṇḍas facing him.

He has many sons —

eighty and eleven —

all of them bearing the same renowned name:

Powerful Ones, they are called, of great strength,

unconquered in battle against gods and asuras

by any other, anywhere.

All of them, upon beholding the perfectly awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
bow to you who are skilled in all things, O man among men:  
"To you, the supreme being, we pay homage!" —  
thus humans have paid homage to you,  
standing at a distance and bowing.  
May you look upon us with virtue.  
We heard again and again  
that even non-humans pay homage to you.  
Therefore I too say this:  
"Seek homage before the Victor, the Guide!  
Seek homage before the Victor Gautama!  
To the buddha endowed with knowledge and conduct perfected,  
to the one who has passed into nirvāṇa, we pay homage!"  
Thus it is that people say the southern direction  
is an auspicious one.  
The great king of renown  
who guards and protects that direction.  
Now regarding only the west —  
that place spoken of in the night,  
where the great sun with its orb of brilliance,  
where the solar parasol sets —  
there is this vast and profound ocean,  
most difficult to cross,  
understood by people as  
the great ocean of manifest waters.  
The great king of renown  
who guards and protects that direction  
is the lord and king of nāgas,  
and his name is known as Virūpākṣa (He of Misshapen Eyes).  
He, together with his kin and companions,  
is always reveling in song and dance,  
surrounded on all sides by nāgas,  
with nāgas facing him.  
He has many sons —  
eighty and eleven —  
all of them bearing the same renowned name:

Powerful Ones, they are called, of great strength,  
unconquered in battle against gods and asuras  
by any other, anywhere.

All of them, upon beholding the perfectly awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
bow to you who are skilled in all things, O man among men:

"To you, the supreme being, we pay homage!" —

thus humans have paid homage to you,  
standing at a distance and bowing.

May you look upon us with virtue.

We heard again and again  
that even non-humans pay homage to you.

Therefore I too say this:

"Seek homage before the Victor, the Guide!

Seek homage before the Victor Gautama!

To the buddha endowed with knowledge and conduct perfected,  
to the one who has passed into nirvāṇa, we pay homage!"

Thus it is that in the western direction  
people come and say "it is good."

The great king of renown  
who guards that direction

is he in whose realm the sound "north" is unpleasant,  
where there is joy and a great beautiful hill to behold,  
where people are born to a lifespan  
of a thousand years,

where they neither scratch nor dig the earth,  
and even when a plow is used the land is not broken up,  
where they are long-lived and possessed of fine complexion,  
where they move about with certainty and ease,  
where the food is rice of fine color,  
fragrance, and taste,

where the flowers gathered there breathe forth fragrance  
and are like the ambrosia of the gods.

When coconuts are boiled

that broth is sought as a condiment, not as a pulse.

In that direction there grow medicinal plants

that blaze up like the tips of flames.  
The great king of renown  
who guards that direction  
is the lord king of the yakṣas,  
and his name is called Vaiśravaṇa.  
Together with his kinsmen  
he always sports with song and dance,  
surrounded by yakṣas on all sides  
and with yakṣas looking on before him.  
He has many sons,  
eighty and eleven,  
all famous under a name that befits them:  
they are called Indra, and they are greatly powerful.  
They are ever unconquered by others  
in the battle between gods and asuras.  
All of them, upon beholding the perfectly awakened buddha,  
the buddha, the kinsman of the sun,  
bow to you who are skilled in all things, O man among men:  
"To you, the supreme being, we pay homage!" —  
thus humans have paid homage to you,  
standing at a distance and bowing.  
May you look upon us with virtue.  
We heard again and again  
that even non-humans pay homage to you.  
Therefore I too say this:  
"Seek homage before the Victor, the Guide!  
Seek homage before the Victor Gautama!  
To the buddha endowed with knowledge and conduct perfected,  
to the one who has passed into nirvāṇa, we pay homage!"  
Thus it is that in the northern direction  
people come and say "it is good."  
The great king of renown  
who guards that direction.  
In the east is Dhṛtarāṣṭra;  
in the south is Virūḍhaka;  
in the west is Virūpākṣa;

in the north is Vaiśravaṇa.

These four great kings,  
renowned as guardians of the world,  
of great miraculous power and great strength,  
guard the four directions.

Sent forth at the kings' command,  
the yakṣas who go about fulfilling every wish  
seek out elephants  
and roam through the directions on all sides.

They seek out riding horses, female elephants, noble stallions, buffalo, goats, sheep, serpents, birds, men, women, young men, and young women, and go about in all directions. A single elephant draws a carriage and goes about in all directions as well. A single riding horse, female elephant, noble stallion, buffalo, goat, sheep, serpent, bird, man, woman, young man, or young woman draws a carriage and goes about in all directions as well.

Of great miraculous power and great strength,  
the yakṣas who go about fulfilling every wish,  
having obtained those conveyances,  
guard the four directions.

The kings' cities  
are many and varied, moving through the sky.

They are as follows: those that travel everywhere and those that do not travel everywhere, those that do not travel over the earth, those that travel over the earth with dancing, those that are hollow, and those called hollow cities. In the northern direction there is a lake called Kapibaṅka. In the western direction there are cities called Sarpavāsa, Gosthala, Gotthalapramukha, Padmāvatī, Supadma, and Pṛthivī.

There is a lake called Adhāra, the abode of many streams. From it flow streams of different kinds, and from it rain falls from the sky.

Venerable one, beyond the hollow city of Uśira:

Those that remain fixed, those with wide extent,  
and those with even greater extent but flowing in channels,  
flowing channels many in number and more than many,  
appearing in the atmosphere of the sky like birds.

Venerable one, in the northern direction beyond the hollow city, there is also an assembly ground called Jāra. There the yakṣas gather and dwell. There are those with ugly feet and hanging lips, and those with terrible, hair-covered bellies. In that place trees bear fruit perpetually. Peacocks, cranes with sweet songs, great cuckoos crying loudly, and śaṅkhatheya birds give forth their calls; peacocks raise their voices, and kaudumbha and chunlak birds and many other birds of various kinds cry out, delighting in the nectar-flavor of flowers. Those of ugly form sport together with songs and dances among the lotus women.

Venerable one, beyond the city of Vānavatī, in the border district, there is a king called Vīra. My assembly ground is called Vṛṣabhadhvaja. My name is Vaiśravaṇa-putra. The words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — ili mili ili mili, kiṭṭi mūle, hili kiṭṭi mūle, huḍu me, huḍu raḍu me, gauri, gandhāri, godohani, oke moke svāhā.

Venerable one, before the Blessed One I will now recite the names of the gandharvas (celestial musicians), the great gandharvas, the gandharva commanders, and the military chiefs. They are as follows:

Those intoxicated by desire, intoxicated by joy,  
intoxicated by song — brothers —  
intoxicated by garlands and intoxicated by honey,  
and brothers intoxicated by flowers,  
those ever intoxicated and intoxicated by glory,  
intoxicated by wealth, the delighter,  
Utpala, Padma, Candra,  
the drum-bearer, the voice of the koel,  
Tumburu, Tukaṅgha,  
the girl who practices with gold, the golden one,  
Pābasang, and Phurbu —  
however many there are who are kings moving about or dwelling —  
these are my brothers, and to them this gandharva who harms me, this  
gandharva who will not release me, I declare this: let them hear it and  
understand clearly.

If any gandharva, gandharva woman, elder gandharva, elder gandharva woman, son of a gandharva, daughter of a gandharva, male attendant of a gandharva, female attendant of a gandharva, male envoy of a gandharva, or female envoy of a gandharva who causes harm, harms — those who watch for

and seek an opening — if some such one should approach, or draw near, or come close, they will find no opening and no ground to stand on. They shall not gain entry into the gathering of gandharvas nor obtain any place in the palace of the king, Vānavatī. Their head shall burst into seven pieces like the ardaka fruit.

If any śrāvaka disciple of the Blessed One — whether a monk or nun, a layman or laywoman — who, in accordance with the sūtra on wandering about and not wandering about, should extensively receive transmission of this dhāraṇī of protection, this vidyā mantra, and this very passage concerning the practice of paying homage at feet, and should recite it — and if any gandharva, gandharva woman, elder gandharva, elder gandharva woman, son of a gandharva, daughter of a gandharva, male attendant of a gandharva, female attendant of a gandharva, male envoy of a gandharva, or female envoy of a gandharva who causes harm, who watches for and seeks an opening, should approach, or draw near, or be found in proximity — that one will find no opening and no ground to stand on, will not gain entry into the assembly of gandharvas, will not obtain any place in the royal palace of Vānavatī, and that one's head shall burst into seven pieces like the ardaka fruit.

The words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — kuṇṭule kuṇṭule kuṇṭule kuṇṭule, ehi ehi, sadāmadtike, sadābhaṇḍinike, tiṣṭha duṣṭa baddho si svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, as for any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — whether a monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — who receives this very transmission extensively and recites it, this sūtra that is in harmony with those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander everywhere, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and its verses of homage to the feet: if any flesh-eater (rākṣasa), female flesh-eater, elder flesh-eater, elder female flesh-eater, son of a flesh-eater, daughter of a flesh-eater, male attendant of a flesh-eater, or female attendant of a flesh-eater, or male envoy of a flesh-eater, or female envoy of a flesh-eater who causes harm, who watches for and seeks an opening, should approach, or draw near, or be found in proximity — that one will find no opening and no ground to stand on, will not gain entry into the assembly of flesh-eaters, will not obtain any place in the royal palace of Vānavatī, and that one's head shall burst into seven pieces like the ardaka fruit.

The words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — hume hume, humile, humilā bātīye svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, I shall now, in the presence of the Blessed One, recite the names of the kumbhāṇḍas, the great kumbhāṇḍas, the chiefs of the kumbhāṇḍa hosts, and their generals. They are as follows:

Jina and Upajina, Kṛmiśa,  
great-ribbed and great-bellied,  
ten-armed, moving straight upon the earth,  
dark on the left side, and red,  
cloud-colored and spotless,  
long-eared and roaring like thunder,  
matted-haired and ten-powered,  
accomplishing existence and fulfilling all desires,  
the steadfast one and the concealer of deeds,  
the three who possess excellent profit,  
all-colored and bright-eyed —  
as many as there are throughout all the realms of their wandering:  
these are my kindred.

To them I declare: "This kumbhāṇḍa harms me; I will not release this kumbhāṇḍa" — and I make this known to them.

The kumbhāṇḍa that harms me,  
the kumbhāṇḍa that I will not release —  
let it hear these well-spoken words,  
and like the skin of the ardaka fruit,  
let its head burst into seven pieces.

The words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — sire bi sire, sire bi sare, sire bi sare, kṛṣṇa cagale, karaḍī, piṃgale svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, as for any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — whether a monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — who receives this very transmission extensively and recites it, this sūtra that is in harmony with those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander everywhere, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and its verses of homage to the feet: if any kumbhāṇḍa (male), female kumbhāṇḍa, elder kumbhāṇḍa, elder female kumbhāṇḍa, son of a kumbhāṇḍa, daughter of a kumbhāṇḍa, male attendant of a kumbhāṇḍa, female attendant of a kumbhāṇḍa, male envoy of a kumbhāṇḍa, or female envoy of a kumbhāṇḍa who causes harm, who watches for and seeks an opening, should approach, or draw near, or be found in proximity — that one

will find no opening and no ground to stand on, will not gain entry into the assembly of kumbhāṇḍas, will not obtain any place in the royal palace of Vānavatī, and that one's head shall burst into seven pieces like the ardaka fruit.

Venerable Blessed One, as for any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — whether a monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — who receives this very transmission extensively and recites it, this sūtra that is in harmony with those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander everywhere, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and its verses of homage to the feet: if any hungry ghost (preta), female hungry ghost, elder hungry ghost, elder female hungry ghost —

— or a son of a hungry ghost, or a daughter of a hungry ghost, or a male retainer of a hungry ghost, or a female retainer of a hungry ghost, or a male or female emissary of a hungry ghost — who does harm, watching for and seeking an opportunity, were to draw near, or stand near, or come near to that person, they would find no opportunity and gain no foothold. They would fail to enter into the assembly-place where the hungry ghosts gather, and they would likewise obtain no dwelling in the palace of the king called Lāṅgalīn. That one's head shall burst into seven pieces like the ardaka fruit.

Now these are the words of the secret mantra: tayathā — yu me yu me, yu mi le, yu mi la vāti ye svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, in the presence of the Blessed One I shall now speak the names of the nāgas, the great nāgas, the nāga chieftains, and the nāga generals. They are as follows:

Joyful and Near-Joyful, Universally Joyful,  
Vast Wealth, and Excellent Jambu,  
Golden, and Yogurt-Horn,  
Hand of Indra, and Auspicious,  
Free from Sorrow, and Sorrow-Dispelled,  
Fully Liberated, and Lord of Victors,  
Broad-Faced, and Splendid-Faced,  
Vaiśālī, and Auspicious-Bow King,  
Great Garland, and Star-Joyful,  
Great Black, and Moving-by-Hand,  
Goat-Guardian, and the Stable One,  
Left-Direction, and likewise Dark,

Blue-Clear-White, and Companion —  
however many there are dwelling and moving throughout:  
these are my kindred,  
and to them I shall announce:  
"This nāga is harming me,  
this nāga will not let me go" —  
and make it known to them.

If any nāga who harms me  
or any nāga who will not release me  
should hear these well-spoken words,  
that one's head shall burst into seven pieces  
like the ardaka fruit.

Now these are the words of the secret mantra: tayathā — ci le vi ci le, ci le vi ci  
le, gaurī, gandhārī, mātaṅgī, caṇḍālī svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, as for any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — whether a  
monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — who  
receives this very transmission extensively and recites it, this sūtra that is in  
harmony with those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander  
everywhere, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and  
its verses of homage to the feet: if any nāga, female nāga, elder nāga, elder  
female nāga, son of a nāga, daughter of a nāga, male retainer of a nāga,  
female retainer of a nāga, or a male or female nāga emissary — who does  
harm, watching for and seeking an opportunity, were to draw near, or stand  
near, or come near to that person, they would find no opportunity and gain no  
foothold. They would fail to enter into the assembly-place where the nāgas  
gather, and they would likewise obtain no dwelling in the palace of the king  
called Lāṅgalīn. That one's head shall burst into seven pieces like the ardaka  
fruit.

Venerable Blessed One, as for any śrāvaka of the Blessed One — whether a  
monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — who  
receives this very transmission extensively and recites it, this sūtra that is in  
harmony with those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander  
everywhere, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and  
its verses of homage to the feet: if any putrid-bodied spirit, female  
putrid-bodied spirit, elder putrid-bodied spirit, elder female putrid-bodied

spirit, son of a putrid-bodied spirit, daughter of a putrid-bodied spirit, male retainer of a putrid-bodied spirit, female retainer of a putrid-bodied spirit, or a male or female emissary of a putrid-bodied spirit — who does harm, watching for and seeking an opportunity, were to draw near, or stand near, or come near to that person, they would find no opportunity and gain no foothold.

They would find no entry into the assembly where yakṣas gather, and they would gain no dwelling in the royal palace of Sudarśana. That one's head would split into seven pieces like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra are these:

tadyathā — abe bahane, bahana batīye svāhā.

Venerable Blessed One, in your presence I shall now recite the names of the yakṣas, the great yakṣas, the chiefs of yakṣa troops, and the commanders of armies. They are as follows:

Indu, Candha, Varuṇa,  
Bharadvāja, lord of creatures,  
Powerful Candana, chief of desires,  
Evil-throated and Sure-necked,  
Mighty Jewel and Jewel-wanderer,  
Supreme Sound and Near-drum,  
Mountain-equal, Gold-possessing, Brimming,  
Acacia-thicket-dweller and Left-marked,  
Yakṣa Vāskyoṇ, Dwelling-in-the-wilds,  
Victor, Chief of the Herd, King of Humans,  
The troop of gandharvas of many kinds,  
Long Iron Spear and Mother-born,  
Five Words Yellow and Joyful,  
Long Yakṣa with his retinue,  
Three Fruits and Triple-necked —  
however many there are who dwell and wander —  
these are my kinsmen. To them I say:  
"This yakṣa harms me. Do not release this yakṣa."  
Thus I speak, and I make it known to them.

The yakṣa that harms me,  
the yakṣa that will not let me go —  
if they hear these words so well spoken,  
their heads shall split into seven pieces

like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra are these:

tadyathā — hili mili, hile mile, kīrtimūle, hili kīrtimūle, otumbe, tumbe, otumpe, tumbe, oghe moghe, godehi, bhṛṃgāre, ṛṣisattame svāhā.

If any śrāvaka, monk or nun, layman or laywoman, who is a disciple of the venerable Blessed One, and who thoroughly receives the transmission of and recites this very sūtra — which accords with the wandering and non-wandering, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and its verses of homage to the feet — if any yakṣa, female yakṣa, elder yakṣa, elder female yakṣa, son of a yakṣa, daughter of a yakṣa, male retainer of a yakṣa, female retainer of a yakṣa, male emissary of a yakṣa, or female emissary of a yakṣa — who does harm, watching for and seeking an opportunity — were to draw near, or stand near, or come near to that person, they would find no opportunity and gain no foothold. They would find no entry into the assembly where yakṣas gather, and they would gain no dwelling in the royal palace of Sudarśana. That one's head would split into seven pieces like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

If any śrāvaka, monk or nun, layman or laywoman, who is a disciple of the venerable Blessed One, and who thoroughly receives the transmission of and recites this very sūtra — which accords with the wandering and non-wandering, together with its knowledge-mantras, its protective formulas, and its verses of homage to the feet — if any rākṣasa, female rākṣasa, elder rākṣasa, elder female rākṣasa, son of a rākṣasa, daughter of a rākṣasa, male retainer of a rākṣasa, female retainer of a rākṣasa, male emissary of a rākṣasa, or female emissary of a rākṣasa — who does harm, watching for and seeking an opportunity — were to draw near, or stand near, or come near to that person, they would find no opportunity and gain no foothold. They would find no entry into the assembly where rākṣasas gather, and they would gain no dwelling in the royal palace of Sudarśana. That one's head would split into seven pieces like the fruit of the arjaka plant.

The words of the secret mantra are these:

tadyathā — hili hili, hulu hulu, yume yumile.

yumilabātīye svāhā.

Having proclaimed these words at length, it bowed its head at my feet in prostration and vanished from sight then and there.

Monks, you should take up this very sūtra — in order to protect and guard yourselves, to dwell in contact with wellbeing, to bring those yakṣas and non-human beings who are inherently malicious and as yet without faith to faith, and to cause those who already have faith to turn back to it again and to flourish — this sūtra that is concordant with wandering and non-wandering, together with its vidyā mantras and protective verses. Prostrations are to be made at its feet. Take it up! Hold it! Carry it! Proclaim it!

Thus did the Blessed One speak. Those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

A mnemonic summary: i, ku, hu, si, yu, tsi, ā, hi, hi. The nine syllables of the secret mantra have been set forth, and are to be applied in sequence.

The Great Sūtra known as the Sūtra Concordant with Wandering and Non-Wandering is complete.

Translated by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Prajñāvarman, together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé and others, and established as a definitive translation.

## Translator's Notes

- The title phrase "wandering everywhere and not wandering everywhere" renders the Tibetan kun tu rgyu ba dang kun tu rgyu ba ma yin pa, which corresponds to the Sanskrit concept distinguishing roaming or pervasive spirits from those that are not roaming. The Āṭānāṭīya is a well-known protective sūtra associated with the Four Great Kings, and this phrase in the title reflects a classification of classes of non-human beings within that tradition.

The phrase rendered "foot-treading salutations" translates sug pa rkang pa la phyag tshal bar gyur ba, a somewhat technical expression in this protective liturgical context. It likely refers to a ritual act of homage performed at the feet of a figure, possibly as part of the protective circuit described in this sūtra, but the precise referent in the ritual tradition is not entirely transparent from the text alone.

The final verse is metrically and syntactically dense. The rendering follows the most natural reading, in which Vaiśravaṇa declares that he protects the eastern direction, associated with the rising of the great sun.

- The passage describes the four great heavenly kings and the directions they guard, following the standard cosmological framework of the Āṭānāṭīya-type sūtras. Dhṛtarāṣṭra guards the East over the gandharvas, Virūḍhaka guards the South over the kumbhāṇḍas, and Virūpākṣa guards the West over the nāgas. The fourth king, Vaiśravaṇa, guardian of the North over the yakṣas, is cut off mid-verse at the passage break.

The phrase rendered "kinsman of the sun" translates རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་, a standard epithet of the Buddha referring to the solar lineage of the Śākya.

The description of the western direction introducing the ocean and night before naming the guardian king is slightly unusual in structure; the Tibetan verses follow the cosmological aside about the setting sun and the deep western ocean as a transition before identifying Virūpākṣa, which is faithfully preserved here.

- The passage is a cosmological-mythological text describing the Four Great Kings (Skt. caturmahārāja) and their realms, likely from the Āṭṇāṭīya-sūtra tradition or a related Pali-Sanskrit cosmological source translated into Tibetan. Several proper names for the cities and the lake in the final section are transliterations of Sanskrit or Prakrit originals that are partially opaque; the renderings given are reconstructed approximations based on phonetic similarity to known parallels in the Āṭṇāṭīya corpus. The phrase rendered "finest of herds" for རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་ is literally "supreme herd-leader" and likely means a prize stallion or a lead animal. The city-type classifications in the penultimate paragraph are technical cosmological categories whose precise referents are uncertain; the translation follows the literal sense.

- The text contains a first-person speech by a yakṣa lord who identifies himself as "Son of Vaiśravaṇa," i.e., a son of the great northern guardian-king Vaiśravaṇa (Kubera). The assembly ground name rendered "the excellent herd" (Uccaiḥśravas) is speculative; the Tibetan khyu mchog can is literally "possessing the best of herds," likely a transcription of a Sanskrit place name now difficult to recover with certainty.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as phonetically as possible from the Tibetan transcription and should be understood as approximate; their Sanskrit originals, if any survive in an independent recension, may differ. The ārdaka plant whose pod splits into seven pieces is a recurring motif in protective dhāraṇī literature as a symbol of total destruction of an adversary's head — a standard curse formula.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, consistent with the continuity note that only this segment is being translated.

- The repeated phrase rendered "accords with the sūtras of the wandering ones and of those who are not wandering ones" reflects a technical division between roaming or itinerant spirit-sūtras and their counterparts; the precise doctrinal referent of this classification is uncertain and may be a specialized regional or ritual category. The kumbhāṇḍa assembly phrase "gru la bum 'du ba" literally suggests gathering in or by boats, which is unusual; it may be a textual corruption or a specialized image, and is rendered literally here. The list of kumbhāṇḍa names in the verse section is rendered according to probable Sanskrit originals where recoverable; several names remain opaque and are given in descriptive English based on the Tibetan sense.

- The Tibetan term lus srul po (literally "decayed body" or "rotting body") corresponds to the Sanskrit vetāla, a type of spirit associated with corpses and charnel grounds; I have rendered it as "corpse-spirit" with the Sanskrit in parentheses on first use. The parallel structure of the passage — repeating the protective formula across preta, nāga, and vetāla categories — is preserved in the translation.

The list of nāga names is a proper-name catalogue and presents genuine philological difficulty, as many names are translated into Tibetan from Sanskrit originals that are not fully recoverable with certainty. The renderings given are based on the literal Tibetan meanings. The palace of the willows, rgyal po'i pho brang lchang lo can, likely refers to a specific mythological location in nāga cosmology, possibly corresponding to the Sanskrit Pāṇḍukambalā or another named nāga palace; the exact identification is uncertain.

- The verse section listing yakṣa names presents genuine difficulties: many names appear to

be transliterations or semantic renderings of Sanskrit proper names for specific yakṣa figures that are not fully recoverable from this Tibetan alone, so the translations given are approximate semantic renderings of the Tibetan. For instance, "Lord of Waters" renders chu lha, "Master of Beings" renders skye dgu'i bdag, and several others follow the same approach. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as the source text provided is itself incomplete at that point.

The phrase kun tu rgyu ba dang kun tu rgyu ba ma lags pa dang mthun pa'i mdo, rendered throughout as "the sūtra in accordance with wandering and non-wandering," likely refers to a category of the protective text suited both to itinerant and non-itinerant practitioners; the precise technical sense of this phrase within the full text's framework is not entirely clear from context alone.

- The phrase "sūtra in accordance with wandering and non-wandering" renders the Tibetan technical phrase (འགྲོ་བར་དང་སྐྱོད་མེད་པུན་ཀློང་གི་སྡེ་སྒྲིག་སྤྱི་ཆ་) throughout. This likely refers to a classification of protective texts applicable both when one is traveling and when one is staying in place; the precise Sanskrit behind "kun tu rgyu ba" may be "*paricāra*" or similar. The doctrinal or textual reference is not entirely certain but the rendering is consistent with the preceding passage.

The final verse section shifts into the voice of Vaiśravaṇa reciting a protective hymn that introduces the Four Great Kings in turn; Dhṛtarāṣṭra is named here as lord of the gandharvas and guardian of the east. The verse breaks off mid-sequence in the Tibetan passage provided.

- The passage is a near-verbatim repeated refrain applied first to the eastern direction, then the southern, then the western — a structural feature of this sūtra (the Āṭānāṭīya-sūtra tradition). The hungry ghosts passage describing the retinue of Virūḍhaka is placed between the eastern and southern sections in the Tibetan; the parallel passage for the western direction describes the ocean. The name Virūpākṣa means "he of distorted or misshapen eyes" and is the standard name of the nāga king who guards the west. The phrase "skilled in all things" renders *cang shes*, a somewhat unusual expression that may carry the sense of "omniscient" or "knowing all things"; its precise nuance is not entirely fixed in this context.

• The names of the four great kings — Dhṛtarāṣṭra, Virūdhaka, Virūpākṣa, and Vaiśravaṇa — are rendered from their standard Sanskrit equivalents as they appear in the Tibetan by epithets and descriptions rather than spelled-out names. The Tibetan uses descriptive titles: "realm guardian" (east), "noble-born man" (south), "ugly-eyed" (west), and "ugly-bodied" (north), which are conventional epithets of the Four Great Kings. These have been rendered by their standard Sanskrit names as recognized throughout the tradition.

The passage listing cities and geographical names in the final prose section contains several proper nouns that are transliterated approximations of Sanskrit or Prakrit originals. The lake name "Kapibañka" and the city names are rendered as close phonetic approximations from the Tibetan syllables; their exact Sanskrit equivalents are uncertain.

- The text is a Vinaya-related or protective sūtra passage listing gandharva kings and their assembly grounds, interspersed with dhāraṇī formulae. The mantra syllables are transliterated as they stand; their Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain in places, which is typical of dhāraṇī literature.

The phrase rendered "those with flowing channels, many in number" relates to a list of city types established in the preceding passage; the verse passage describing fixed and moving cities continues that enumeration.

The term rendered "ardaka fruit" is a Sanskrit plant name left untranslated as it is a technical botanical reference; its head-bursting curse formula is a conventional protective imprecation

found widely in dhāraṇī literature.

"Vaiśravaṇa-putra" literally means "son of Vaiśravaṇa" — that is, a son of the great yakṣa king Vaiśravaṇa (Kubera), and this is the speaker's self-identification.

• The verse section listing the names and epithets of the kumbhāṇḍa chiefs presents several proper names whose Sanskrit originals are partially recoverable from the Tibetan phonetic renderings and semantic glosses. "Jina and Upajina" renders འཇམ་དབྱེ་འཇམ་པའི་པོ་ (standard epithets in such protective lists). "Kṛmiśa" renders ཀླུ་མཚན་པོ་ phonetically. "Ten-powered" renders རྩ་བཅུ་པོ་, a stock epithet. The phrase

𑀓𑁄𑀭𑀮𑀢𑀺𑀣𑀲𑀸𑀳𑀾𑀤𑀻𑀧𑀼𑀱𑀽𑀢𑀿𑀇𑀶𑀯𑀸𑀨𑀹𑀺𑀴𑀻𑀰𑀽𑀡𑀺𑀩𑀻𑀏, rendered "śūtra in harmony with those who wander everywhere and those who do not wander everywhere," is a technical designation whose exact referent within the larger text's classification system is not fully transparent; it likely refers to categories of the yakṣa or spirit assembly addressed in the broader śūtra context.

• The palace name Lāṅgalīn renders the Tibetan lcam lo can, literally "having willow leaves" or "the willow-adorned." This appears to be a standard name for the abode of a nāga king, paralleling the preceding context of Vānavatī. It is rendered by its likely Sanskrit reconstruction Lāṅgalīn here as a working equivalent, though the exact Sanskrit is not certain from the Tibetan alone.

The beings called *lus srul po* are literally "putrid-bodied ones" or "corpse-bodied ones," a class of malevolent spirit not corresponding to a single well-attested Sanskrit term in this sūtra's context. They are rendered descriptively as "putrid-bodied spirits" throughout.

The names in the nāga list are rendered into English meaning where transparent and left as transliterated forms where they appear to be proper names resisting clean translation. Some names in this list are difficult to identify with precision; the rendering reflects the most plausible readings.

• The royal palace "Sudarśana" renders སུད་རམ་ས་, literally "having willows" or "having leafy branches," which is a standard Tibetan rendering of Sudarśana, the name of Indra's celestial palace. This is the standard identification in the commentarial tradition, and the context here — exclusion from a place of divine privilege — supports reading it as a supernatural royal seat, likely Indra's palace rather than a terrestrial one.

The list of yakṣa names in verse is a transliteration-based roster of proper names. Many are opaque or corrupted in transmission, and the English renderings given are best-attempt semantic translations of the Tibetan phonetic equivalents. The proper Sanskrit originals are uncertain for several entries, and a specialist in Buddhist proper-name lists would need to consult parallel Sanskrit or Chinese witnesses to establish the originals with confidence.

The term arjaka (Tibetan: འརྒྱཅ་པ་) is a plant, likely *Ocimum gratissimum* or a related species whose seed capsule or fruit pod splits dramatically when ripe — a common image in Buddhist apotropaic literature for the shattering of an enemy's head.

- The phrase "concordant with wandering and non-wandering" renders kun tu rgyu ba dang kun tu rgyu ba ma yin pa dang mthun pa'i mdo, which is the title of the sūtra. The precise doctrinal referent of "wandering and non-wandering" is not fully transparent from the text alone; it likely refers to beings who roam through cyclic existence and those who do not, but the title is preserved as-is per the sūtra's own usage throughout.

The mnemonic syllable summary is a standard Tibetan device for indexing the mantra syllables of the text and is rendered as a simple list without further gloss, as it functions as a practical aide-mémoire rather than as translatable doctrinal content.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.